

**UNIT
19**

POEMS

UNIT 19 POEMS

Wind on the Hill

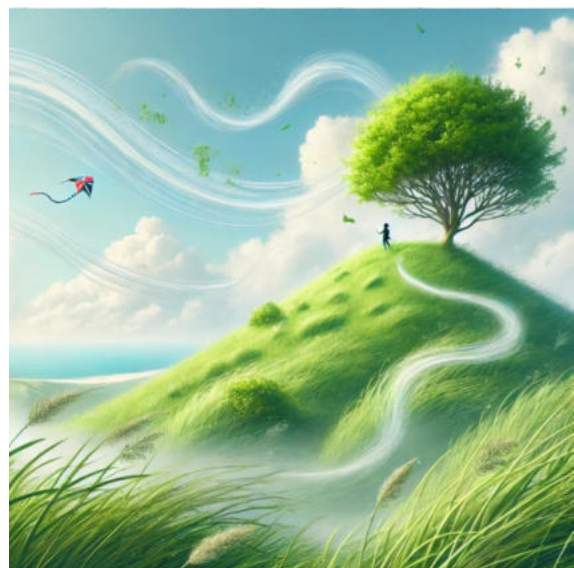
A.A. Milne (Alan Alexander Milne) was a famous **English poet** and author. He was born on **January 18, 1882**, in **London, England**. Milne is best known for writing the **Winnie-the-Pooh** stories, but he was also a **poet** who wrote beautiful and simple poems for children.

No one can tell me,
Nobody knows,
Where the wind comes from,
Where the wind goes.

It's flying from somewhere
As fast as it can,
I couldn't keep up with it,
Not if I ran.

But if I stopped holding
The string of my kite,
It would blow with the wind
For a day and a night.

"By A.A. Milne"



Short-Answer Questions

1) What will happen if the poet stops holding the string of his kite?

2) Can anyone tell the poet from where the wind comes?

Write "True" or "False" next to each statement.

1) The poem Wind on the Hill is written by Shakespeare. _____

2) A.A.Milne is famous for writing Pink Panther stories. _____

3) The poet couldn't keep up with the wind's speed. _____

The Rainbow

Christina Rossetti was a famous English poet who lived in the **19th century** (1830–1894). She is known for her beautiful poems, many of which are about **love**, **faith**, and **nature**. She was part of a family that loved art and poetry, and her brother, **Dante Gabriel Rossetti**, was also a famous poet and artist.

Boats sail on the rivers,
And ships sail on the seas;
But clouds that sail across the sky
Are prettier far than these.

There are bridges on the rivers,
As pretty as you please;
But the bow that bridges heaven,
And overtops the trees,
And builds a road from earth to sky,
Is prettier far than these.

“by Christina Rossetti”



Short-Answer Questions

1) What according to the poet is prettier than boats and ships?

2) What is the bridge that connects Earth with sky?

2) What according to the poet sails in the sky?

Write "True" or "False" next to each statement.

1) Christina Rossetti was a Pakistani poet. _____

2) Rainbow is prettier than bridges on the rivers. _____

3) Ships sail on the seas. _____

The Swing

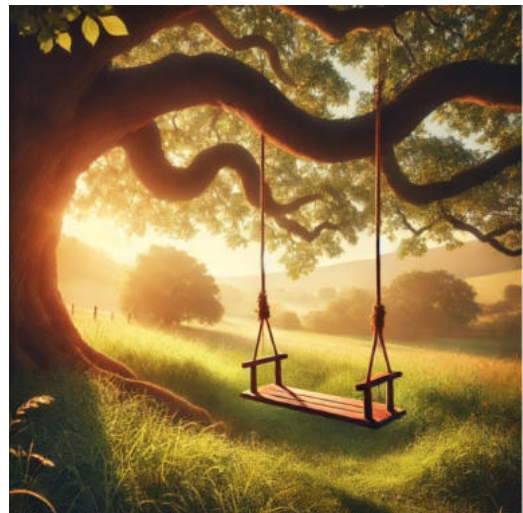
Robert Louis Stevenson was a famous Scottish writer, born on **November 13, 1850**, in **Edinburgh, Scotland**. He wrote exciting adventure stories like "**Treasure Island**" (about pirates) and "**Dr Jekyll and Mr Hyde**" (about a man with two personalities). Stevenson loved to travel and wrote many of his stories based on his adventures. Despite being sick for much of his life, he kept writing until he passed away in 1894. Today, he is remembered for his thrilling tales.

How do you like to go up in a swing,
Up in the air so blue?
Oh, I do think it the pleasantest thing
Ever a child can do!

Up in the air and over the wall,
Till I can see so wide,
Rivers and trees and cattle and all
Over the countryside—

Till I look down on the garden green,
Down on the roof so brown—
Up in the air I go flying again,
Up in the air and down!

"by Robert Louis Stevenson"



Short-Answer Questions

1) What is the main activity described in the poem?

2) How does the child feel about going up in the swing?

3) What things can the child see when he goes high in the air?

4) What does the child see when he looks down from the swing?

5) How does the child describe the garden and the roof from the swing?

6) What do you think the child likes about swinging in the poem?

7) How does the poet describe the swing in the poem?

EXERCISES

Exercise: 1

Read the following statements. Write "True" or "False" next to each one.

- 1) The child in the poem likes to go high in the swing. _____
- 2) The child can see the sea and mountains from the swing.

- 3) The child feels excited and happy when swinging. _____
- 4) The child can see gardens, roofs, rivers, and trees from the swing. _____
- 5) The child only swings up and never comes back down.

Exercise: 2

Complete the sentences using the words from the poem: (wall, flying, roof, rivers, brown)

- 1) The child describes the roof as _____.
- 2) The child feels like they are _____ in the air.
- 3) The child swings up and over the _____.
- 4) The child can see _____ and trees from high up.

Creative Writing

Imagine you are the child in the poem. Write 2–3 sentences about how you would feel if you were swinging. What do you think you'd see or feel?

Discussion Question

- 1)** Why do you think the poet describes the swing as "the pleasantest thing"?
- 2)** Do you think the child is enjoying the experience of swinging? Why?
- 3)** Have you ever gone on a swing? What do you like about it?